MATIAS AHRENSDORF

New York, NY · 704-575-2724 · matiasahrensdorf@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/matiasahrensdorf

Data and research analyst who takes public data end to end: sourcing it (FOIL, IPUMS, Census, NIBRS, HUD), modeling it (Python, fixed-effects panel regression, PCA, ML imputation), and shipping it (Snowflake/Tableau pipelines and published writing). Research support for nationally recognized scholars; 10+ bylines in the *Wall Street Journal*, *City Journal*, and *RealClear*.

EXPERIENCE

Manhattan Institute — *Data & Software Engineer* New York, NY · Apr 2024 – Present

- Build end-to-end research pipelines for scholars and fellows, sourcing and modeling federal and municipal data (IPUMS, Census/NHGIS, NIBRS, HUD, CDC, SEER, GSS) into analysis-ready panels; work has supported a TED talk, a published book, and multiple institute reports.
- Ran fixed-effects panel regressions on a **74,000-row county-by-year panel** for Roland Fryer's TED talk on hip-hop's cultural influence, with clustered standard errors and survey weighting; **re-specified the exposure variable to be standardized within each subset**, making effect sizes comparable across race and age cohorts, and rebuilt the regression code into a single parameterized function with built-in robustness checks.
- Consolidated **3.4M 311 service requests across 15 of the 25 largest U.S. cities** — each with an incompatible schema — plus NIBRS petty-crime and HUD homelessness counts, into a unified public-disorder dataset for a senior fellow.
- Modeled judicial leniency across **454,000 NYC arraignment records**, using PCA and residualized regression to separate judge-specific behavior from case mix.
- Built **LLM integrations via MCP servers connecting Snowflake and Airtable**, plus reverse-ETL jobs feeding modeled data into custom CRM fields, replacing recurring manual pulls for the development and marketing teams.
- File FOIL requests on behalf of scholars pursuing government data, including a **two-year action against the MTA** that escalated to outside counsel and ended in full production of the requested dataset.
- Publish analysis and data visualizations in the *Wall Street Journal*, *City Journal*, *RealClear*, and *Compact*; manage content and releases across three web properties (manhattan.institute, City Journal, Adam Smith Society).

LS Direct Marketing — *Financial Analyst* Suffern, NY · Jan 2023 – Apr 2024

- Built and automated the CFO's core reporting stack — sales tax, deferred revenue, COGS, commissions, and budget-vs-actuals — replacing manual Excel workflows with Python/Pandas scripts.
- Managed source databases and built validation checks reconciling reporting across departments, catching discrepancies before they reached leadership.
- Produced Tableau dashboards presented at board meetings, tracking company and client performance trends.

Compass Group — *Sr. Payroll Analyst* Charlotte, NC · Sep 2021 – Jan 2023

- Automated manual payroll processes and led the transition to paperless operations, eliminating recurring processing hours and reducing labor-cost leakage.
- Built KPI and trend reporting, and delivered training webinars translating payroll data issues into decisions for operations management.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Wall Street Journal (opinion) · *City Journal* (4) · *RealClearMarkets / Defense / Books* (3) · *Compact* · *Washington Examiner* · Manhattan Institute report on indexing New York State taxes to inflation. Beats: Latin America policy and financial risk. **Full list:**

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Analysis: Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, statsmodels, linearmodels, pyfixest, geopandas), SQL, R, JavaScript
Methods: Fixed-effects panel regression, clustered standard errors, PCA, random forests, KNN imputation, geospatial analysis, survey microdata (IPUMS, GSS), FOIA/FOIL research
Data & Platform: Snowflake, Tableau, reverse ETL, MCP servers / LLM integration, Airtable, Zapier, AWS, MongoDB, React/Node.js, WordPress
Business: Financial reporting automation, forecasting, data validation, board reporting
Other: Spanish (bilingual) · Microsoft Excel (MOS Certified)

EDUCATION

Elon University — B.S. Business Administration, Finance; Minor, Spanish Language & Literature 2020
Presidential Scholar · National Hispanic Honor Society · Study abroad: Barcelona, Spain; Japan & South Korea

University of North Carolina at Charlotte — Full-Stack Web Development Bootcamp 2022